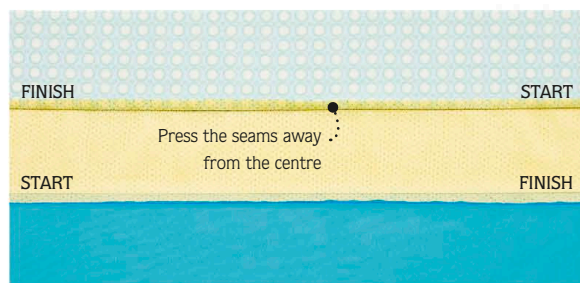


► STRIP PIECING

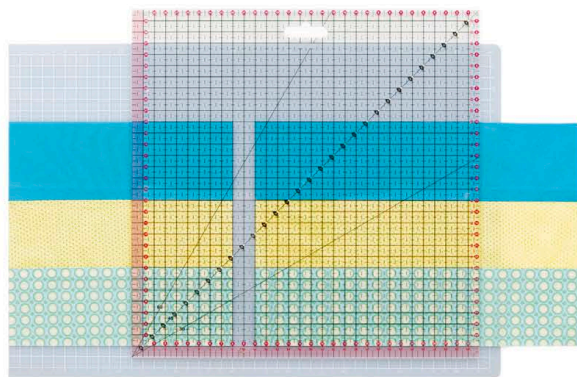
Strip piecing is a good way to build blocks quickly. In principle, several long strips are joined – or pieced – and then cut apart before being stitched together again in a

different sequence. It is the method by which many blocks can be made, including Log cabin (see pp.92–93) and Seminole patchwork (see pp.99–101).

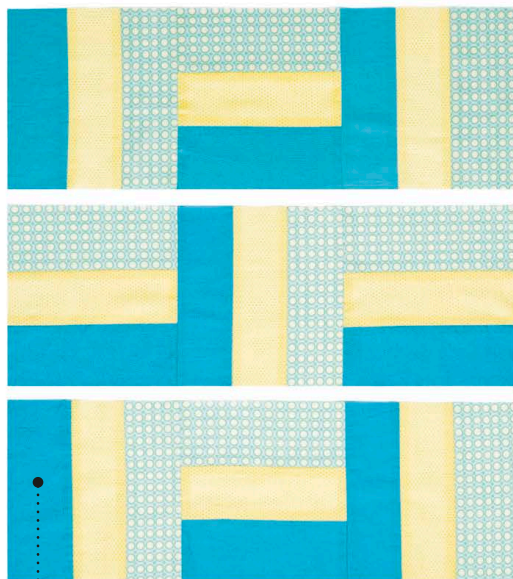
STRIP-PIECED BLOCKS: RAIL FENCE



1 Cut three strips of equal width from three contrasting fabrics. With right sides together, stitch them lengthways, leaving a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance. To prevent the pieced strip from bowing, join strips 1 and 2, then reverse the direction of sewing to add strip 3. Press the seams to one side, away from the centre.



2 Using a rotary cutter and quilter's ruler, measure the width of the pieced strip and cut across it to make squares the same size on each side as this measurement.



3 Following the layout, arrange the squares in rows of three. With right sides together, join the squares to make three rows, leaving a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance. Press, alternating the direction in each row.



4 With right sides together, join the rows, matching the seams and leaving a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance.